Business Studies Task 1 2015/2016 HSC

Markers Feedback

In all, this task was well done by many students. The use of case study/ies by students was very strong and clearly an effort had been made to prepare and remember data about a range of businesses. Students were able to, at the very least, make reference to case study/ies and many were able to use mostly relevant case studies.

The use of business terminology and concepts was also quite strong. Most students used the correct terms in the Influences section of the syllabus and when examining impacts on operations, were able show how this impacted strategies and/or processes.

The key part of the criteria that led to a mark distribution amongst the students was the ability of students to "make well reasoned judgments" as opposed to make "some judgments" or even to "provide characteristics & features with some possible impact" The following aspects of the essays were the typical areas that the markers felt let students down:

- Many students chose case study examples that didn't really demonstrate the influence that they were trying to assess. For example, students wanted to examine globalization impacted Zara and then told us that they actually reduced their distribution centres and made most of their goods in Spain.
- Many students wanted to use criteria. Most of the time, the criteria was so tightly aligned to the particular strategy and its outcome that they made little sense. If you want to use criteria in an assess essay, you need to be much more thoughtful about the criteria you use to judge the impact of an operational influence.
- Many students really wanted to write a strategy essay and align it to business success. This meant that a lot of the time the essays were not really focused on the impact of an influence but more told the story of a strategy and how this strategy created business success. Some students made an off the cuff statement that the business used this to respond to an influence but that was about it.

The key learning is to use this feedback and consider very carefully the examples you use to demonstrate linkages. Also, answer the question asked. We got the feeling that students were re-hashing exemplar essays that were answering
different questions.

Below you will find some annotated essay paragraphs that fall into different band ranges. Look at the writing and the annotation to try and understand how we used the criteria and how you can improve in the Sem 1 exam when you write an extended response like this on the Finance topic.